

WHIFFS OF INSIGHT



INDIA'S FRAGRANCE MARKET IS PEGGED AT \$2.5 BILLION, WITH LUXURY ALONE A \$1 BILLION OPPORTUNITY



SPENDING PATTERNS SHOW INDIANS ARE COMFORTABLE PAYING ₹10,000-₹12,000 FOR LUXURY PERFUMES, WITH DISCOVERY SETS AND SMALLER BOTTLES SERVING AS GATEWAYS FOR FIRST-TIME BUYERS



BRANDS LIKE DAVIDOFF, BVLGARI, AND GUCCI ARE STRENGTHENING THEIR PRESENCE, WHILE NICHE NAMES SUCH AS KILIAN PARIS AND DIPTYQUE ARE ENTERING INDIA TO TAP RISING ASPIRATIONS



WITH UNDER PENETRATION, A YOUNG ASPIRATIONAL BASE, AND CENTURIES-OLD OLFACTORY HERITAGE, INDIA HAS THE POTENTIAL NOT JUST TO CONSUME BUT TO REDEFINE THE GLOBAL NICHE PERFUME CATEGORY



BY 2029, FRAGRANCE USERS IN INDIA ARE EXPECTED TO TOUCH 121 MILLION, WITH PENETRATION INCREASING 8.2%

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HEN LADY MACBETH hopelessly proclaimed that all the opulent scents of Arabia—symbols of luxury and

sensual excess—were not enough to rid her of her guilt in *Macbeth*, fragrance came to assume more significance in Shakespeare's dramatic universe. It became a metaphor for power, identity, and the burden of memory. In a world far from the Scottish moors and Arabian souks, that same metaphor finds new meaning in India, where the ancient art of perfumery is witnessing a revival. Here, in the land of *attars*—Kannauj has been distilling scent for generations—the aromatic opulence once invoked by Shakespeare is both alive and evolving.

Luxury fragrances, once reserved for the elites and film stars, are now being claimed by a growing tribe of In-

dian consumers. Advisory and consulting firm Basic Roots pegs Indian fragrance industry at \$2.5-billion, growing at a robust 15% compound annual growth rate (CAGR), at an inflection point. From Parisian maisons to homegrown labels, India's perfume story is being reshaped by an aspirational shift toward luxury.

Within India's fragrance industry, the luxury segment alone is a \$1-billion opportunity, expanding at 9% annually, according to a report by Basic Roots. Unsurprisingly, global powerhouses are rushing in. Over the past few years, labels such as Kilian Paris and Essential Parfums have made their entry, joining established names like Bvlgari, Gucci, and Davidoff that already cater to India's rising appetite for fine scents.

"Luxury fragrance in India is no longer about access—it's about shaping culture and creating experient-

THE NOTES

Luxury fragrances are crafted in smaller batches with rare ingredients and layered compositions

